INCIDENT CFN · DELETE_FAILED

BACK IN 2 HOURS.

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200 resources, parent stack in DELETE_FAILED. We took the surgical path, not the 4-5 hour backup restore.

STATE POST-CASCADE

FRIDAY, MIDDAY.

~200	**3**	**0**
RESOURCES IN SCOPE	STACKS IN DELETE_FAILED	DATA RESOURCES LOST

OPTIONS TWO PATHS

BOTH VIABLE.

4-5H	2H
RESTORE FROM BACKUP	SURGICAL IMPORT

INSIGHT NON-DESTRUCTIVE

RUN **BOTH**.

Resource import is **non-destructive.**
Kick off the backup as the parachute. Worst case you switch lanes with no progress lost.

TECHNIQUE LOAD-BEARING

SAME-NAME PARENT.

Create a tiny CFN parent with the same name as the original. Import the orphans under it. Your full template redeploy is just a **stack update**.

PRIMITIVES FOUR

FOUR BLOCKS.

- **Retain** on data AND nested-stack wrappers
- **Same name** parent as the target stack
- **Strip** the original template, don't rewrite
- **Hardcode** ARNs where cross-stack refs lived

GAP IDENTIFIED

AWS DOCUMENTS THIS IN HALVES.

Retain-on-delete is one doc. Resource import is another. The composition isn't in any single runbook.

READ FULL BREAKDOWN

PARACHUTE OPEN.

Two hours with the restore playbook running in parallel beats four to five with no upside.

FULL ARTICLE

jasonmatthew.dev/blog/cloudformation-surgical-recovery